

United Kingdom — Student Visa & Study Abroad Guide

Updated: September 2026

Important: This is general educational information, not legal, immigration or financial advice. Visa rules, fees, financial thresholds, processing times and document requirements can change. Always verify the current official authority and institution requirements before applying.

Official immigration resources

Visa guidance: <https://www.gov.uk/student-visa>

Immigration / study information: <https://www.gov.uk/student-visa>

At a glance

Visa / route	Student visa
Common intakes	September is the main intake; January and selected other intakes depend on the institution.

Typical student visa pathway

1. Choose a course and a licensed Student sponsor.
2. Apply to the institution and satisfy its academic/English requirements.
3. After the required offer conditions are met, obtain the CAS reference/evidence from the sponsor.
4. Prepare passport, financial evidence and any additional documents required for your circumstances.
5. Complete the online Student visa application and required biometrics/identity steps; review visa conditions before travel.

Common supporting documents

- Valid passport or travel document
- CAS information from the licensed Student sponsor
- Financial evidence if required under the current rules
- Evidence relating to ATAS if applicable to the course/nationality
- TB test certificate if required for the applicant's country of residence
- Parental consent and relationship evidence for applicants where the rules require it
- Translations for documents not in English or Welsh where required

United Kingdom: planning your study application

Admission and visa are separate decisions

A university offer does not by itself guarantee a visa. First confirm the exact programme admission conditions and deadline; then follow the current immigration route and evidence requirements for your nationality and circumstances.

Study planning checklist

- Compare universities and course modules, not only university names.
- Check tuition fees, scholarships and living costs on official institution pages.
- Confirm the exact English-language and academic requirements for the chosen programme.

After arrival

- Carry your passport and immigration documents when travelling.
- Check the visa/eVisa status and conditions before starting study.
- Complete any university registration and accommodation steps.
- Follow work, attendance and sponsorship conditions attached to the visa.

Before submitting your visa application

- Check passport validity and identity details.
- Use the latest official application form/process for your country of residence.
- Make sure names, dates and education history are consistent across documents.
- Keep copies of submitted forms, receipts, appointment confirmations and supporting evidence.
- Check whether documents need certified translation and whether originals must be presented.
- Review the exact visa conditions after grant before travelling.

Useful official links

- [Official visa guidance](https://www.gov.uk/student-visa) — <https://www.gov.uk/student-visa>
- [Official immigration/study information](https://www.gov.uk/student-visa) — <https://www.gov.uk/student-visa>

ViaSphere counsellor checklist

Use this page as a preparation worksheet. The exact evidence depends on the student, programme, nationality and current rules.

Area	Check	Status
Course	Programme, duration, level and campus confirmed	■
University	Official programme/admissions page reviewed	■
English test	Accepted test and minimum section/overall scores checked	■
Academic documents	Transcripts/certificates and translations checked	■
Funds	Current official financial evidence requirements checked	■
Passport	Validity and personal details checked	■
Accommodation	Plan/evidence prepared if required	■
Insurance/health	Current requirement checked	■
Visa application	Current official route and forms checked	■
Arrival	Registration/orientation/travel plan prepared	■

Official-source rule

If this guide conflicts with an official immigration authority, embassy/consulate, university or testing-provider page, follow the current official source. ViaSphere should not be treated as the issuing authority for any visa or admission decision.